

CORY COWDEN

San Francisco Bay Area, CA | coryfrancis10@gmail.com | [LinkedIn](#) | [GitHub](#) | [Portfolio](#)

Education

University of California, Santa Cruz — M.S. in Human-Computer Interaction *Incoming Fall 2026*

California Polytechnic State University, San Luis Obispo — B.S. in Software Engineering *Sep 2024 – June 2026*

- Cru Cal Poly Community Group Leader (2025–2026): Led weekly small group Bible studies for transfer students
- Member of Cru, UX Fest, WISH (Women in Software/Hardware), and Swim Club

Hartnell College — A.S. in Computer Science *Aug 2022 – May 2024*

- GPA: 3.9 — President's List '23–'24
- Intercollegiate Swim Team – School Record 800 Free Relay, '24 Top Female Swimmer
- MESA (Math, Engineering, Science Achievement) Program

Experience

Product Operations Apprentice, 2 Degree Shift — Remote *Jul 2026 – Present*

- Built and tested Airtable and Gravity Forms workflows supporting subscriber onboarding, content management, and product operations
- Conducted and documented accessibility testing using Lighthouse, axe DevTools, and WAVE
- Drafted and tested short-form SMS training messages for daily AI learning and habit-building programs

Support Intern, Farm-ng (Bonsai Robotics) — Watsonville, CA *Jun 2025 – Aug 2025*

- Designed and developed a Report Issue app for the Farm-ng Amiga robot frontend
- Created UI mockups in [Figma](#) and assisted on-site with installation and troubleshooting
- Tested software, helped assemble robots, and supported customer documentation

Research Intern, Blue Marble Space Institute of Science *Jun 2024 – Aug 2024*

- Analyzed biological vs. non-biological signals using complexity theory to identify universal life signatures

Arduino, Electrical Soldering, and Oscilloscope Intern, NASA, Hartnell College — Salinas, CA *May 2023 – Oct 2023*

- Developed Arduino code and designed the “Project M.A.M.A.” rover prototype while gaining hands-on experience with soldering, wiring, and hardware integration

Projects

Caritas Valencia Mobile App (Team Project) — Cal Poly *Sep 2025 – Jun 2026*

- Partnered with Caritas Valencia (Spain) to design a mobile app that improves technician and volunteer workflows for homeless outreach documentation
- Developed a high-fidelity [Figma](#) prototype for the technician workflow, incorporating stakeholder feedback through Agile sprint reviews
- Led and facilitated stakeholder usability testing and created an [alpha site](#) to support cross-testing, developer handoff, and project documentation

Athleat: Student-Athlete Nutrition App (Team Project) — Cal Poly *Sep 2025 – Dec 2025*

- Designed and implemented a nutrition planning app for community college student athletes focused on day-to-day meal planning under demanding schedules
- Conducted user interviews and needfinding, translated findings into a high-fidelity onboarding flow in [Figma](#), and iterated through prototype feedback
- Implemented the working frontend for the onboarding flow from the team's Figma prototype